Teacher Guide & Answers

Passage Reading Level: Lexile 900

1. What position did David normally play for the varsity baseball team?

- **A** right fielder
- **B** pitcher
- **C** **left fielder**
- **D** catcher

2. What conflict does David face in the story?

- **A** Coach Adams moved David to the junior varsity baseball team after David failed to get a hit in the last game against the Barons.
- **B** Coach Adams welcomed David on the varsity baseball team even though David was only a sophomore.
- **C** David is asked to play left fielder in the big game against the Barons even though he actually wants to play catcher.
- **D** **David is asked to play catcher in the big game against the Barons even though he doesn't want to play catcher.**

3. "However, David did not really want to play catcher. He only agreed to it because of the lessons his parents taught him about respecting adults, especially coaches. In David's mind though, he thought playing catcher would be too difficult for him and the rest of the team would suffer as a result."

What can be concluded about how David feels based on this evidence?

- **A** David was beginning to question the lessons his parents taught him about respecting adults.
- **B** **David feared he would not be a good catcher and would hurt the team's chances of winning as a result.**
- **C** David was annoyed that he had to practice being a catcher even though he really liked being the left fielder.
- **D** David was certain he would help his team win the game even though being catcher would be too difficult for him.

4. How did the Woodchucks team benefit when David played catcher?

- **A** David played so well as catcher on the Woodchucks team that the team was able to easily beat the Barons.
- **B** Other players on the Woodchucks team had to work even harder to make up for the bad way David played as catcher.
- **C** **Other players on the Woodchucks team had the chance to play really well because of David's new position.**
- **D** The Woodchucks team was able to beat the Barons because of the number of hits David got.

5. What is the main theme of this story?

- **A** the importance of baseball in a young man's life
- **B** the importance of moving on after loss
- **C** the drawbacks of being motivated by fear
- **D** **the importance and benefits of helping a group**

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6. Read the sentence: "Like most teenaged boys, he enjoyed going for pizza and ice cream with his friends; he even **relished** studying history lessons out of his textbook. The thing David liked to do most though was play baseball."

What does the word "**relished**" mean as used in this sentence?

A enjoyed
B detested
C consumed
D achieved

7. Choose the answer that best completes the sentence below.

_____ David initially did not want to play catcher, David knew that a big reason for the Woodchucks' victory was that he agreed to be the catcher.

A Although
B Because
C Instead
D However

8. Why does Coach Adams ask David to play catcher?

Suggested answer: Coach Adams asked David to play catcher because he was the hardest worker on the team and was confident he was the one player who could handle it. Students may also note that Coach Adams asked David to play catcher because Sammy hurt himself and could no longer be the catcher for the team.

9. Describe the two ways David's position as catcher influenced the performance of other players on the Woodchucks team. Use evidence from the story to support your answer.

Suggested answer: Students should note the following:

- Corey, the pitcher, told David throughout the game that David was giving him excellent choices of pitches to throw, and Corey pitched the best game of the year.
- David's move to the catcher position allowed Derek to take David's left field position. Derek hit a home run in the sixth inning, helping the Woodchucks win. If David had been in left field, this may not have happened.

10. The author states that David loved playing catcher because "he could help the Woodchucks win in ways he never could before." In what ways can David help the team win in ways he never could before? Use information from the story to support your answer.

Suggested answer: Answers may vary and should be supported by the passage. For example, students may explain that David's position as catcher allowed him to effectively support the other members on the team such as when he gave Corey strong choices of pitches to throw. More advanced answers may explain that David became an even stronger positive example for his team members, as he stepped up and became catcher for the team, even though it was a difficult thing for him to do. This may inspire other team members to contribute to the greater good of the team and help the team win.

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